

16

KIA Tactical Grammar

e5-e6 sacrifices, knight jumps, h-file openings, and the calculation rules behind the attack.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will connect tactical motifs to positional preconditions so famous sacrifices become calculated tools rather than guesses.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate White's candidates, find Black's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 091 | PAGE 4

Decode: The e5-e6 clearance sacrifice*A clearance sacrifice needs an open line, an entering piece, and a forcing second move.*

LESSON 092 | PAGE 8

Play: The e5-e6 clearance sacrifice*A clearance sacrifice needs an open line, an entering piece, and a forcing second move.*

LESSON 093 | PAGE 12

Decode: Ng5 and the h7 pressure point*A pawn recapture is dangerous when it opens a file for a heavy piece, not merely when it approaches the king.*

LESSON 094 | PAGE 16

Play: Ng5 and the h7 pressure point*A pawn recapture is dangerous when it opens a file for a heavy piece, not merely when it approaches the king.*

LESSON 095 | PAGE 20

Decode: The h-pawn sacrifice for lines*A sacrificial pawn must open a square or file that a prepared piece can occupy.*

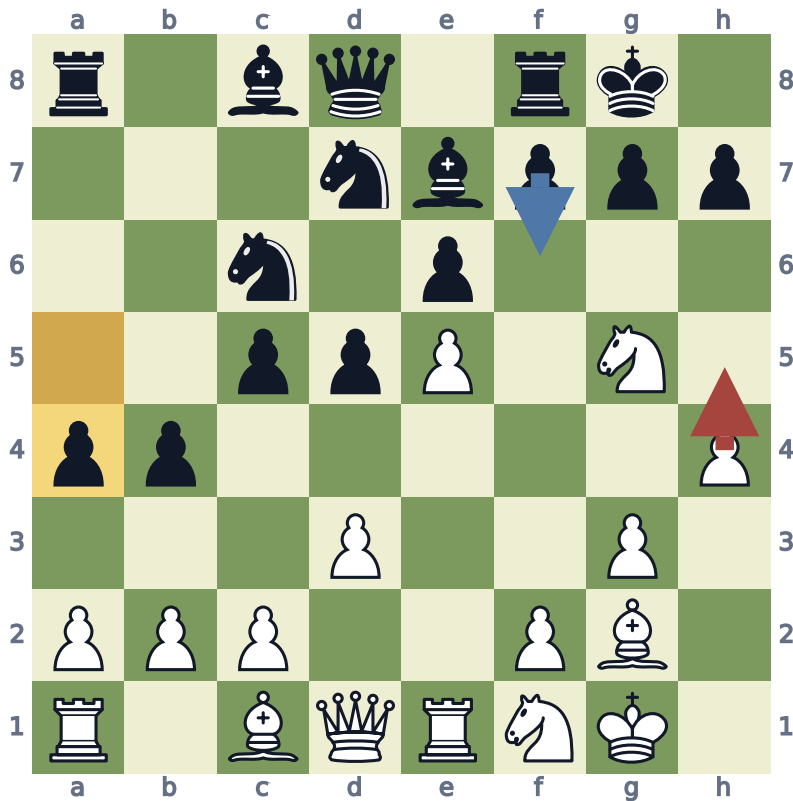
LESSON 096 | PAGE 24

Play: The h-pawn sacrifice for lines*A sacrificial pawn must open a square or file that a prepared piece can occupy.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will connect tactical motifs to positional preconditions so famous sacrifices become calculated tools rather than guesses.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The e5-e6 clearance sacrifice



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

After f5 draws the e6 pawn away, e5-e6 can sacrifice the advanced pawn to open files, dislodge f7, and give the rook or queen entry squares against the king.

DECISION RULE

After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black calculates whether accepting leaves enough defenders, declines when the closed position is safer, and returns material to trade attackers.

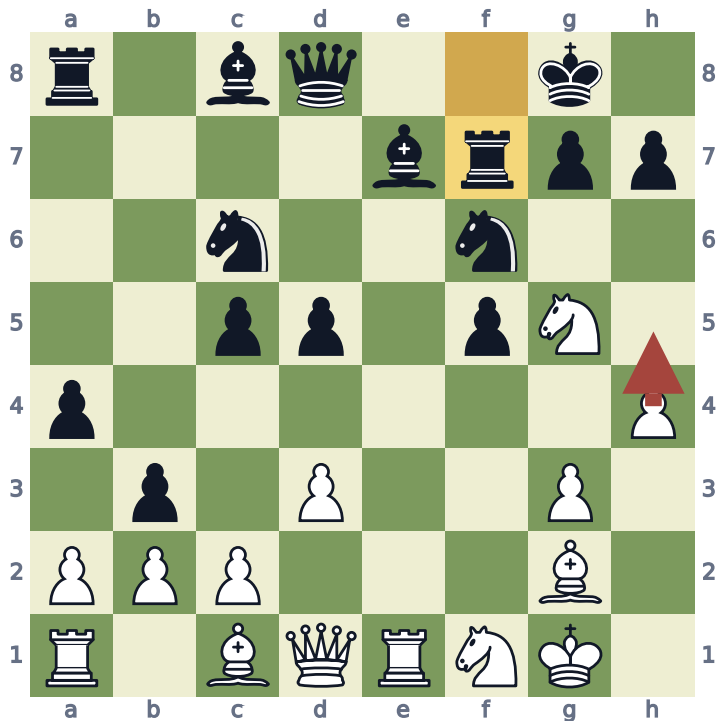
WHITE'S PLAN

White plays e6 only when a rook, queen, or bishop can use the opened line immediately and the return sacrifice remains forcing.

MEMORY RULE | A clearance sacrifice needs an open line, an entering piece, and a forcing second move.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

After f5 draws the e6 pawn away, e5-e6 can sacrifice the advanced pawn to open files, dislodge f7, and give the rook or queen entry squares against the king.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black calculates whether accepting leaves enough defenders, declines when the closed position is safer, and returns material to trade attackers.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White plays e6 only when a rook, queen, or bishop can use the opened line immediately and the return sacrifice remains forcing.

FAILURE MODE

Sacrificing the e-pawn because the motif is famous when the e-file has no attacker.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

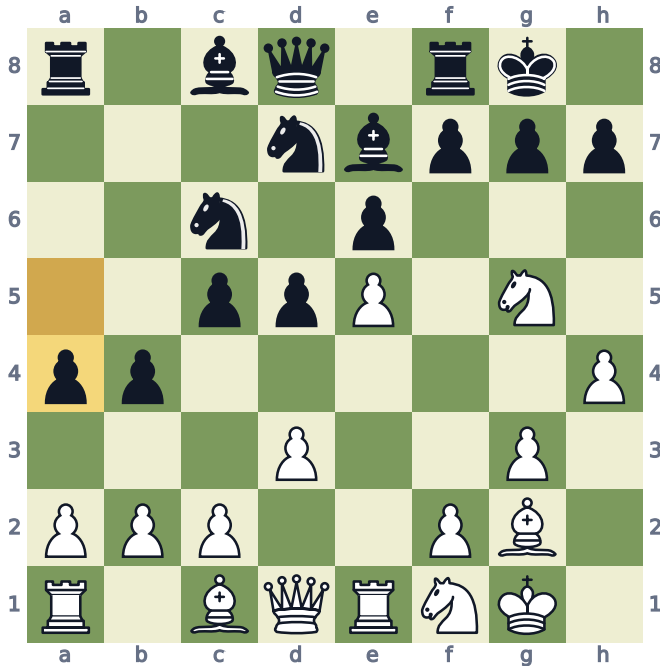
RULE | A clearance sacrifice needs an open line, an entering piece, and a forcing second move.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. Ng5 a4 13. f4 b3 14. f5 exf5 15. e6 Nf6 16. exf7+ Rxf7



- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- b4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Ng5: White reroutes a knight to g5; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- a4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

After f5 draws the e6 pawn away, e5-e6 can sacrifice the advanced pawn to open files, dislodge f7, and give the rook or queen entry squares against the king.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece? White's attacking or positional plan is: White plays e6 only when a rook, queen, or bishop can use the opened line immediately and the return sacrifice remains forcing. The line fails as a template when: Sacrificing the e-pawn because the motif is famous when the e-file has no attacker.

STORE THIS | A clearance sacrifice needs an open line, an entering piece, and a forcing second move.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

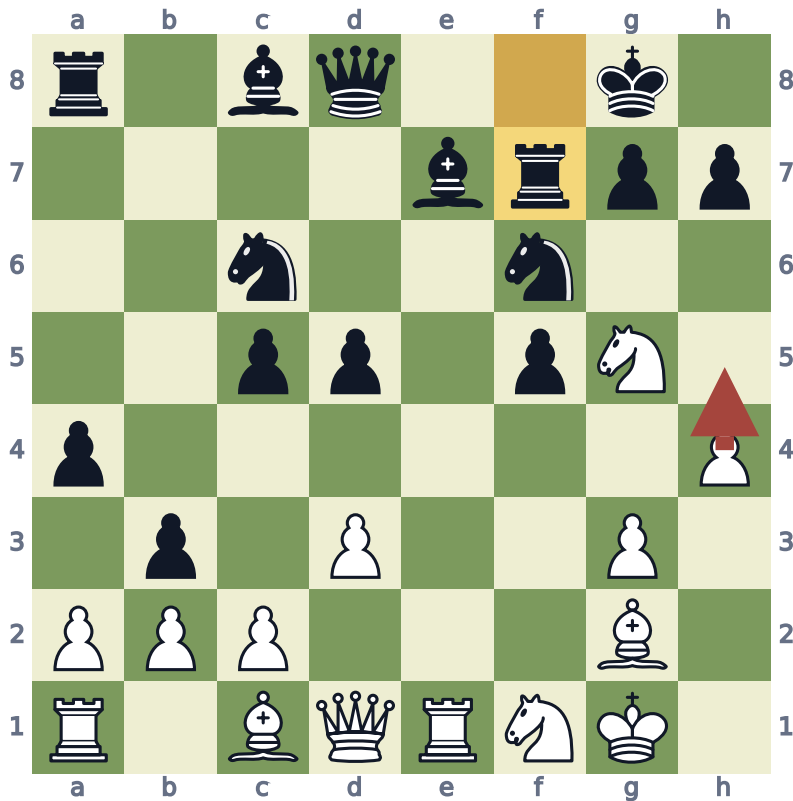
1. After f5 draws the e6 pawn away, e5-e6 can sacrifice the advanced pawn to open files, dislodge f7, and give the rook or queen entry squares against the king. 2. Black calculates whether accepting leaves enough defenders, declines when the closed position is safer, and returns material to trade attackers. 3. White plays e6 only when a rook, queen, or bishop can use the opened line immediately and the return sacrifice remains forcing. 4. After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece? 5. Sacrificing the e-pawn because the motif is famous when the e-file has no attacker.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 24 plies from memory, then replay: 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. Ng5 a4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The e5-e6 clearance sacrifice



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

After f5 draws the e6 pawn away, e5-e6 can sacrifice the advanced pawn to open files, dislodge f7, and give the rook or queen entry squares against the king.

DECISION RULE

After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black calculates whether accepting leaves enough defenders, declines when the closed position is safer, and returns material to trade attackers.

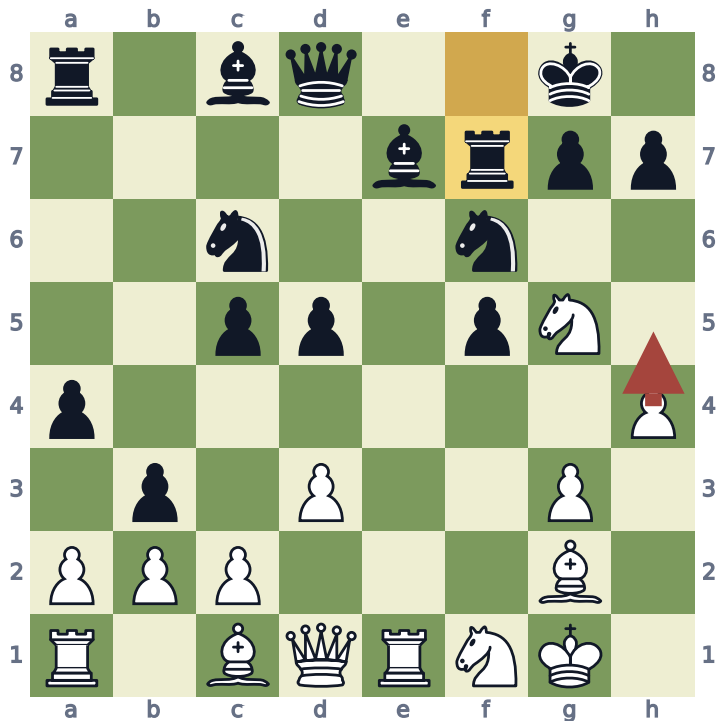
WHITE'S PLAN

White plays e6 only when a rook, queen, or bishop can use the opened line immediately and the return sacrifice remains forcing.

MEMORY RULE | A clearance sacrifice needs an open line, an entering piece, and a forcing second move.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

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BLACK AIMS FOR

Black calculates whether accepting leaves enough defenders, declines when the closed position is safer, and returns material to trade attackers.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White plays e6 only when a rook, queen, or bishop can use the opened line immediately and the return sacrifice remains forcing.

FAILURE MODE

Sacrificing the e-pawn because the motif is famous when the e-file has no attacker.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

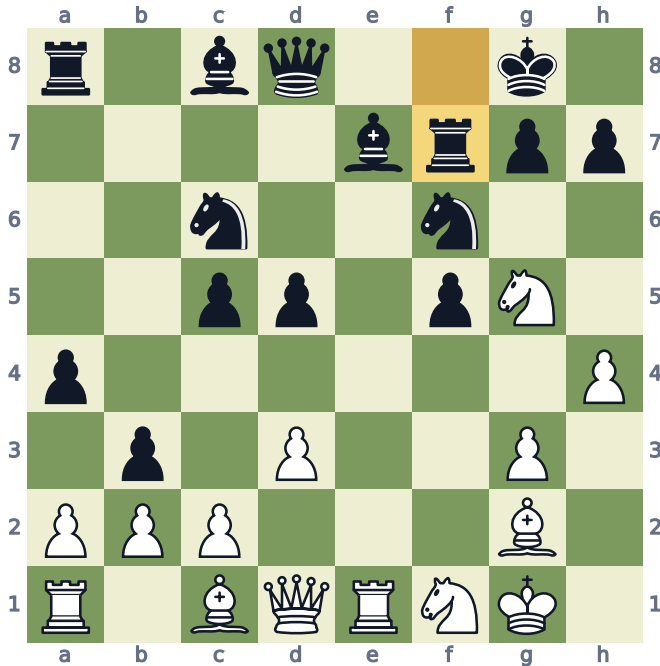
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- f5: White makes line-opening contact with e6 or g6.
- exf5: Black releases tension on f5; recalculate the pawn chain, open files, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- e6: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- exf7+: White releases tension on f7; recalculate the pawn chain, open files, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Rxf7: Black releases tension on f7; recalculate the pawn chain, open files, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

After f5 draws the e6 pawn away, e5-e6 can sacrifice the advanced pawn to open files, dislodge f7, and give the rook or queen entry squares against the king.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece? White's attacking or positional plan is: White plays e6 only when a rook, queen, or bishop can use the opened line immediately and the return sacrifice remains forcing. The line fails as a template when: Sacrificing the e-pawn because the motif is famous when the e-file has no attacker.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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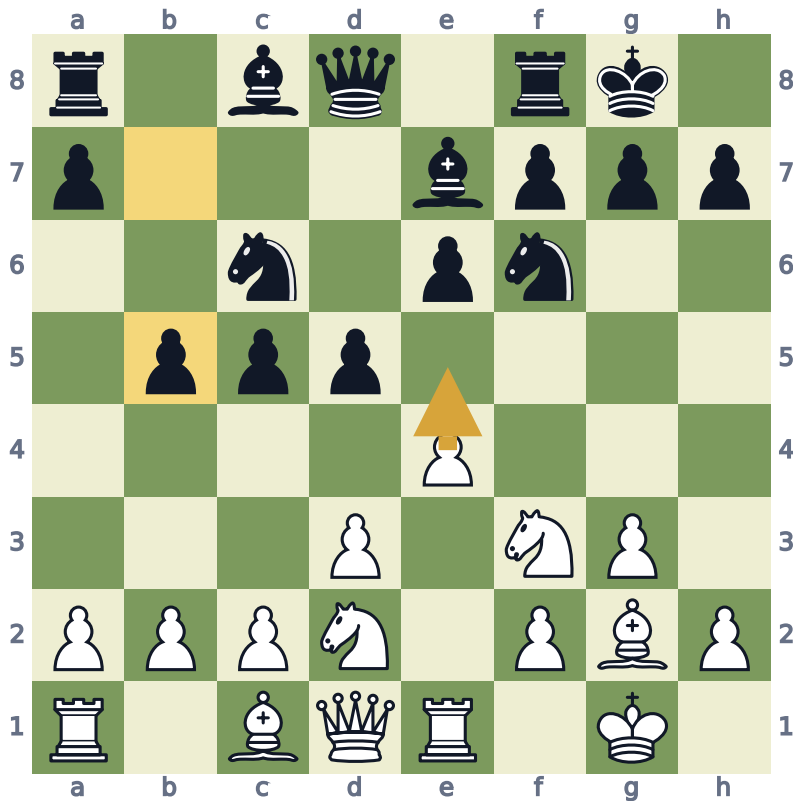
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 32 plies from memory, then replay: 14. f5 exf5 15. e6 Nf6 16. exf7+ Rxf7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Ng5 and the h7 pressure point



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Ng5 increases pressure on h7 and e6 and may invite ...Bxg5, when the h-pawn recapture opens the h-file and preserves attacking material.

DECISION RULE

After ...Bxg5 hxg5, who controls h-file entry squares and can Black close or trade the attacking rook?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black exchanges the knight only if the opened h-file can be controlled, or challenges e5 so the knight loses support.

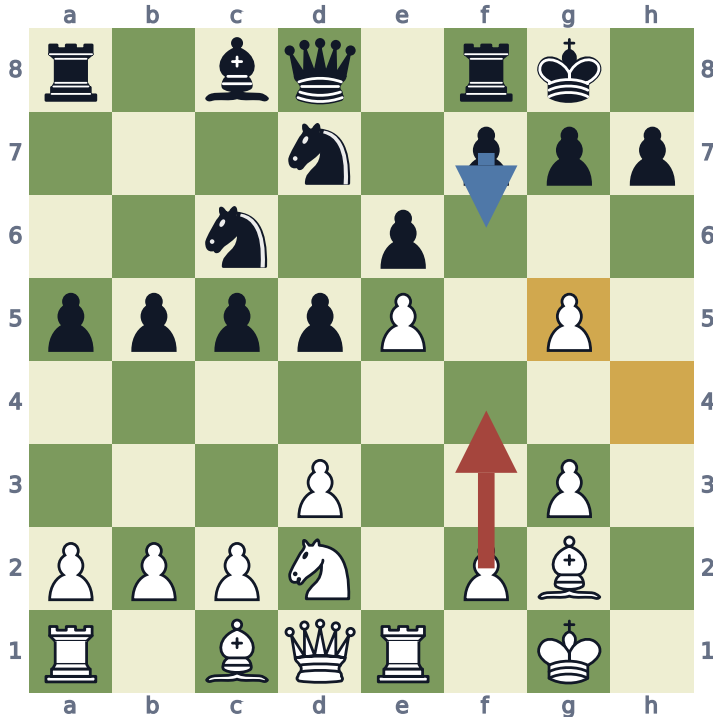
WHITE'S PLAN

White checks whether the h-file opens toward the king and whether a rook or queen can enter before accepting the exchange.

MEMORY RULE | A pawn recapture is dangerous when it opens a file for a heavy piece, not merely when it approaches the king.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Ng5 increases pressure on h7 and e6 and may invite ...Bxg5, when the h-pawn recapture opens the h-file and preserves attacking material.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black exchanges the knight only if the opened h-file can be controlled, or challenges e5 so the knight loses support.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White checks whether the h-file opens toward the king and whether a rook or queen can enter before accepting the exchange.

FAILURE MODE

Allowing the exchange because doubled g-pawns look attacking while no heavy piece reaches the h-file.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After ...Bxg5 hxg5, who controls h-file entry squares and can Black close or trade the attacking rook? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

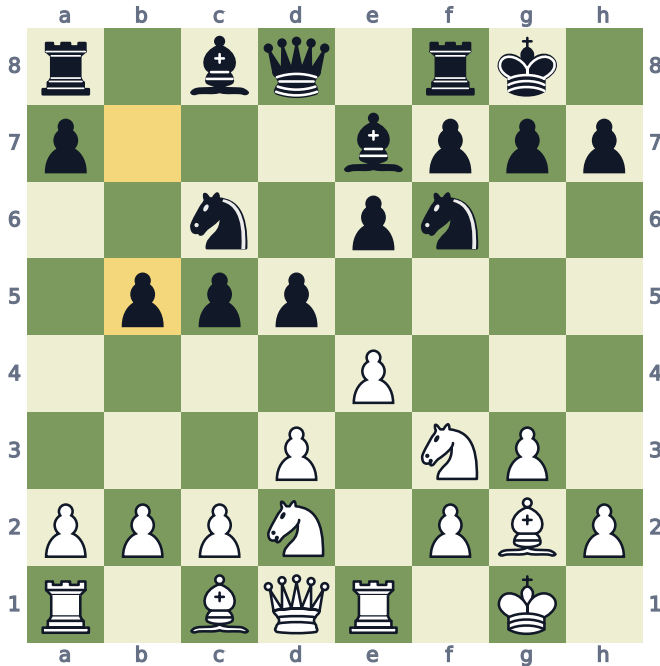
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Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Ng5 Bxg5 12. hxg5



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Ng5 increases pressure on h7 and e6 and may invite ...Bxg5, when the h-pawn recapture opens the h-file and preserves attacking material.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After ...Bxg5 hxg5, who controls h-file entry squares and can Black close or trade the attacking rook? White's attacking or positional plan is: White checks whether the h-file opens toward the king and whether a rook or queen can enter before accepting the exchange. The line fails as a template when: Allowing the exchange because doubled g-pawns look attacking while no heavy piece reaches the h-file.

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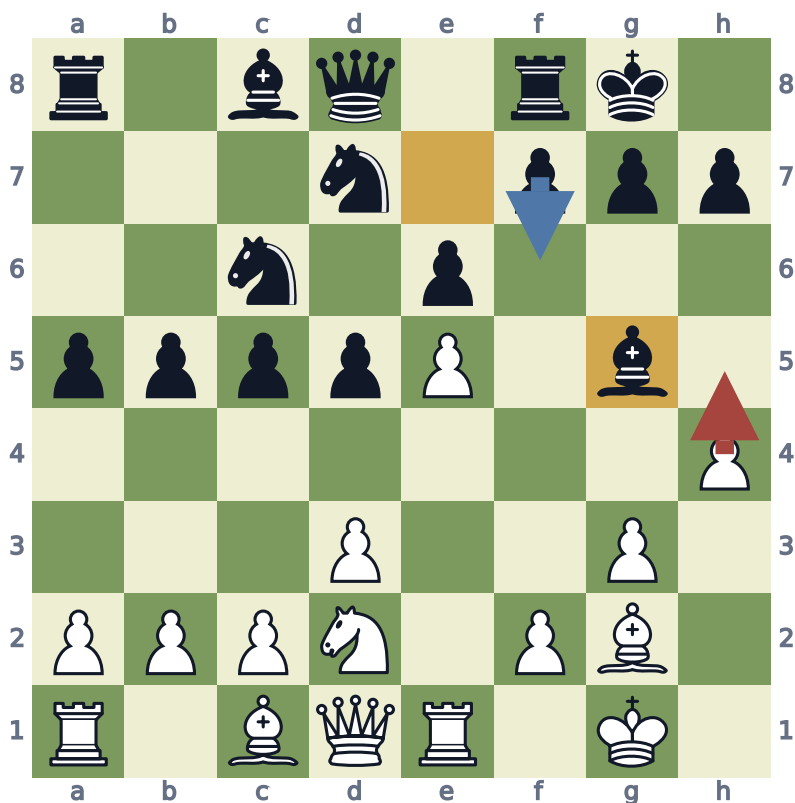
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Ng5 and the h7 pressure point



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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DECISION RULE

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SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

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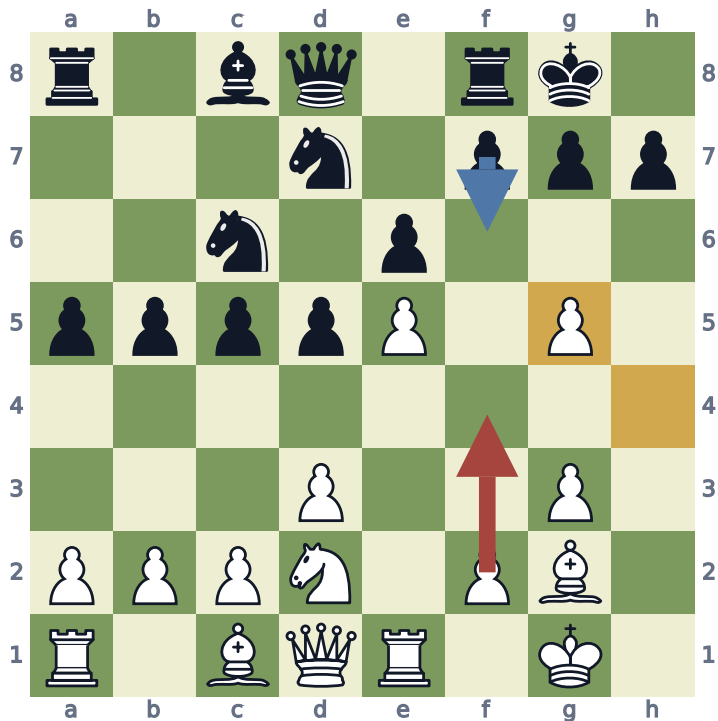
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White checks whether the h-file opens toward the king and whether a rook or queen can enter before accepting the exchange.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

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BLACK AIMS FOR

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

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FAILURE MODE

Allowing the exchange because doubled g-pawns look attacking while no heavy piece reaches the h-file.

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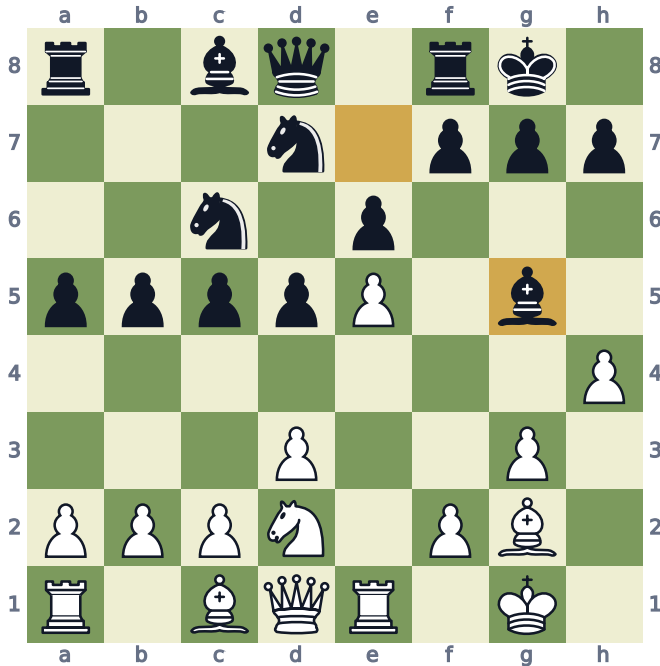
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Ng5: White reroutes a knight to g5; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Bxg5: Black releases tension on g5; recalculate the pawn chain, open files, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

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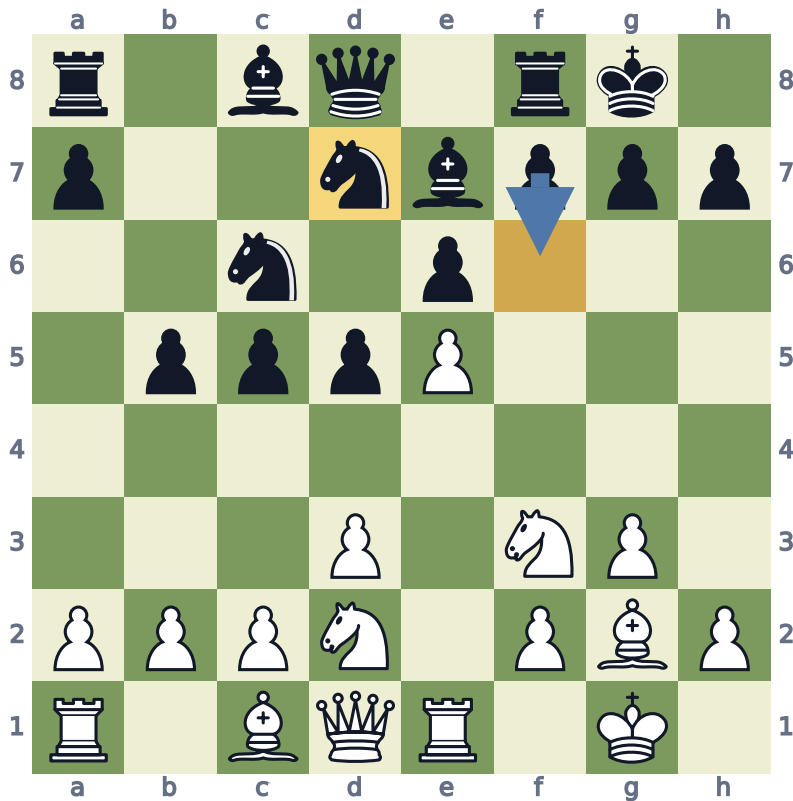
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Ng5 Bxg5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The h-pawn sacrifice for lines



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

h5-h6 can fix or sacrifice the pawn to weaken g6 and h7, but the locked pawn may also become irrelevant if White cannot break the dark squares.

DECISION RULE

If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps files closed, returns a pawn if it trades queens, and counterattacks the center or queenside.

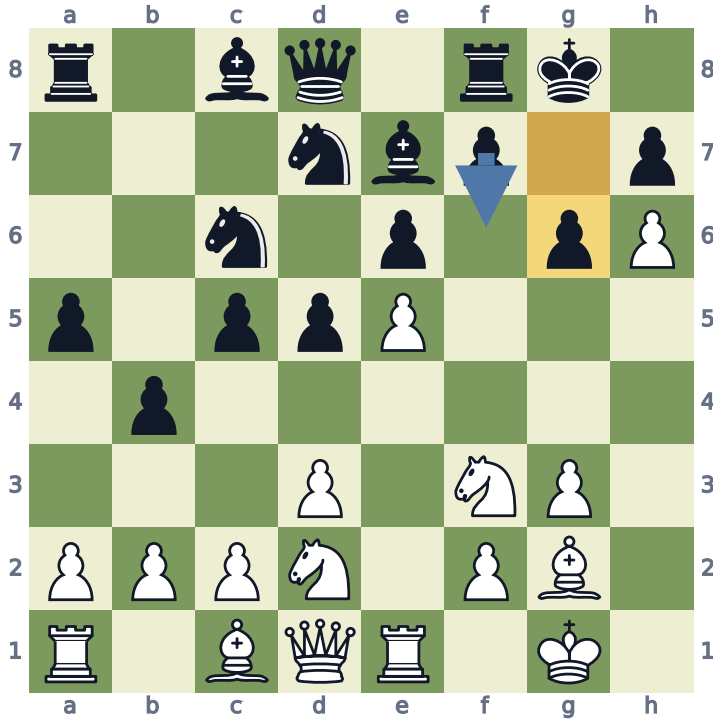
WHITE'S PLAN

White combines the pawn with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen entry so a capture opens a usable line.

MEMORY RULE | A sacrificial pawn must open a square or file that a prepared piece can occupy.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

h5-h6 can fix or sacrifice the pawn to weaken g6 and h7, but the locked pawn may also become irrelevant if White cannot break the dark squares.

BLACK AIMS FOR

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White combines the pawn with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen entry so a capture opens a usable line.

FAILURE MODE

Pushing the pawn beyond the point of contact and leaving it blockaded as a decorative wedge.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

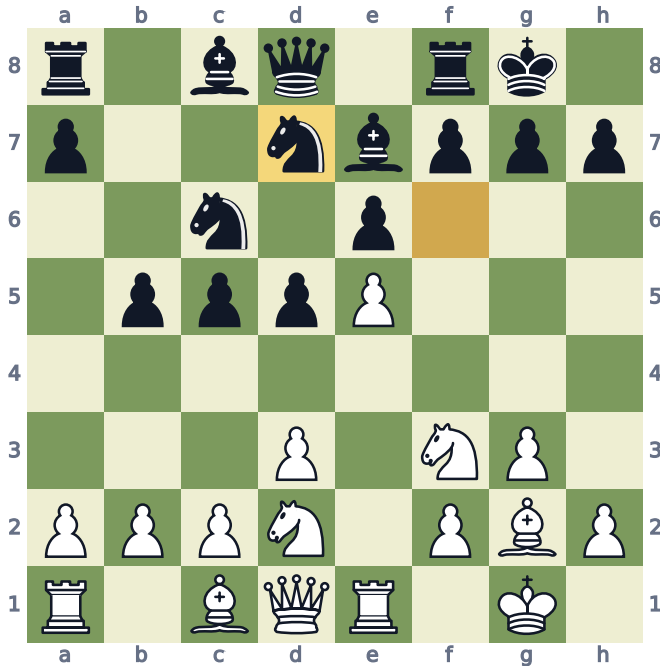
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Move-by-move meaning

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- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
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WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

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ANSWER KEY

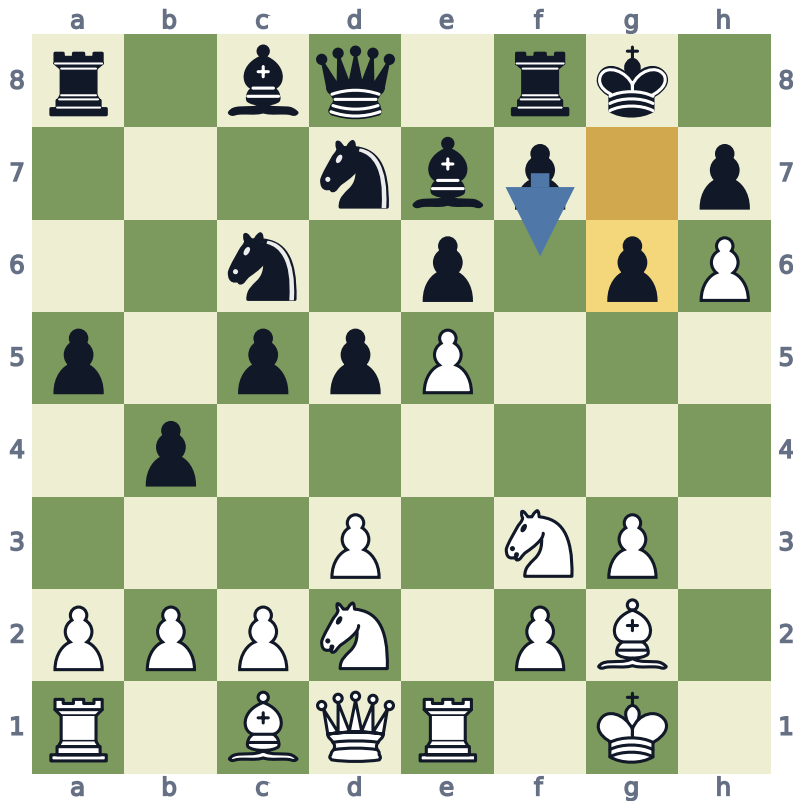
1. h5-h6 can fix or sacrifice the pawn to weaken g6 and h7, but the locked pawn may also become irrelevant if White cannot break the dark squares. 2. Black keeps files closed, returns a pawn if it trades queens, and counterattacks the center or queenside. 3. White combines the pawn with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen entry so a capture opens a usable line. 4. If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next? 5. Pushing the pawn beyond the point of contact and leaving it blockaded as a decorative wedge.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The h-pawn sacrifice for lines



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

h5-h6 can fix or sacrifice the pawn to weaken g6 and h7, but the locked pawn may also become irrelevant if White cannot break the dark squares.

DECISION RULE

If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps files closed, returns a pawn if it trades queens, and counterattacks the center or queenside.

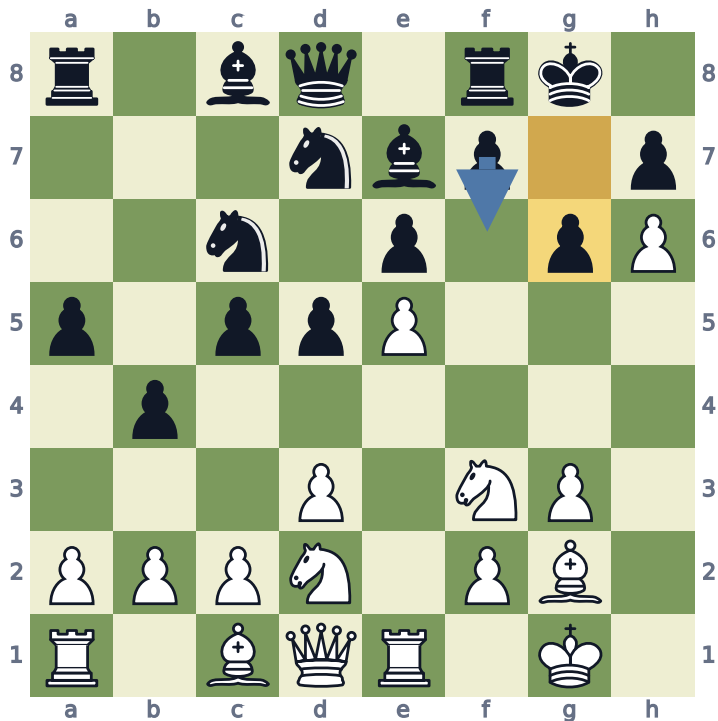
WHITE'S PLAN

White combines the pawn with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen entry so a capture opens a usable line.

MEMORY RULE | A sacrificial pawn must open a square or file that a prepared piece can occupy.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

h5-h6 can fix or sacrifice the pawn to weaken g6 and h7, but the locked pawn may also become irrelevant if White cannot break the dark squares.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black keeps files closed, returns a pawn if it trades queens, and counterattacks the center or queenside.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White combines the pawn with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen entry so a capture opens a usable line.

FAILURE MODE

Pushing the pawn beyond the point of contact and leaving it blockaded as a decorative wedge.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

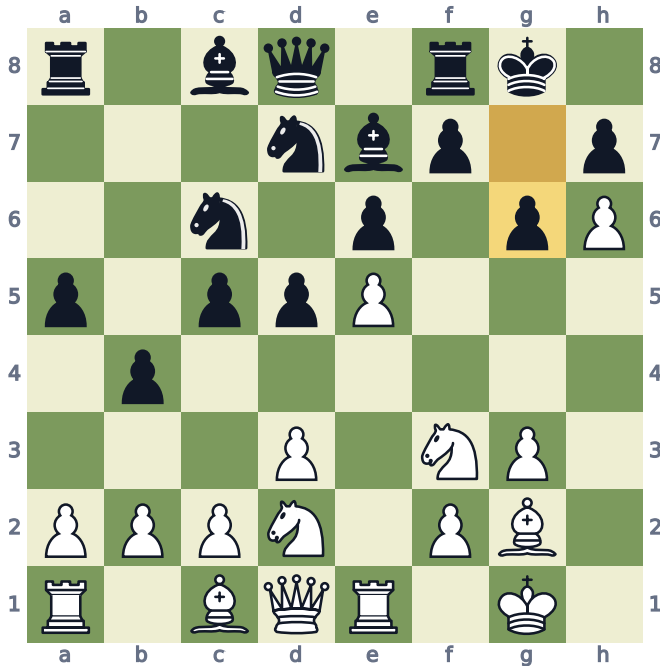
RULE | A sacrificial pawn must open a square or file that a prepared piece can occupy.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. h5 b4 12. h6 g6



- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- h5: White fixes kingside squares and asks whether White can attack the fixed pawn.
- b4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- h6: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

h5-h6 can fix or sacrifice the pawn to weaken g6 and h7, but the locked pawn may also become irrelevant if White cannot break the dark squares.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next? White's attacking or positional plan is: White combines the pawn with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen entry so a capture opens a usable line. The line fails as a template when: Pushing the pawn beyond the point of contact and leaving it blockaded as a decorative wedge.

STORE THIS | A sacrificial pawn must open a square or file that a prepared piece can occupy.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. h5-h6 can fix or sacrifice the pawn to weaken g6 and h7, but the locked pawn may also become irrelevant if White cannot break the dark squares. 2. Black keeps files closed, returns a pawn if it trades queens, and counterattacks the center or queenside. 3. White combines the pawn with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen entry so a capture opens a usable line. 4. If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next? 5. Pushing the pawn beyond the point of contact and leaving it blockaded as a decorative wedge.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 24 plies from memory, then replay: 10. h4 a5 11. h5 b4 12. h6 g6

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 091 Decode: The e5-e6 clearance sacrifice

Prompt: After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece?

Recall: A clearance sacrifice needs an open line, an entering piece, and a forcing second move.

LESSON 092 Play: The e5-e6 clearance sacrifice

Prompt: After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece?

Recall: A clearance sacrifice needs an open line, an entering piece, and a forcing second move.

LESSON 093 Decode: Ng5 and the h7 pressure point

Prompt: After ...Bxg5 hxg5, who controls h-file entry squares and can Black close or trade the attacking rook?

Recall: A pawn recapture is dangerous when it opens a file for a heavy piece, not merely when it approaches the king.

LESSON 094 Play: Ng5 and the h7 pressure point

Prompt: After ...Bxg5 hxg5, who controls h-file entry squares and can Black close or trade the attacking rook?

Recall: A pawn recapture is dangerous when it opens a file for a heavy piece, not merely when it approaches the king.

LESSON 095 Decode: The h-pawn sacrifice for lines

Prompt: If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next?

Recall: A sacrificial pawn must open a square or file that a prepared piece can occupy.

LESSON 096 Play: The h-pawn sacrifice for lines

Prompt: If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next?

Recall: A sacrificial pawn must open a square or file that a prepared piece can occupy.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's counterplay, White's plan, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The e5-e6 clearance sacrifice

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. Ng5 a4 13. f4 b3 14. f5 exf5 15. e6 Nf6 16. exf7+ Rxf7

Decision: After ...fxe6, what is White's first forcing move and can Black exchange the invading piece?

Memory: A clearance sacrifice needs an open line, an entering piece, and a forcing second move.

CARD 2

Ng5 and the h7 pressure point

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Ng5 Bxg5 12. hxg5

Decision: After ...Bxg5 hxg5, who controls h-file entry squares and can Black close or trade the attacking rook?

Memory: A pawn recapture is dangerous when it opens a file for a heavy piece, not merely when it approaches the king.

CARD 3

The h-pawn sacrifice for lines

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. h5 b4 12. h6 g6

Decision: If Black captures or ignores h6, which white piece reaches g7, h7, or the h-file next?

Memory: A sacrificial pawn must open a square or file that a prepared piece can occupy.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
091 Decode: The e5-e6 clearance sacrifice	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
092 Play: The e5-e6 clearance sacrifice	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
093 Decode: Ng5 and the h7 pressure point	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
094 Play: Ng5 and the h7 pressure point	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
095 Decode: The h-pawn sacrifice for lines	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
096 Play: The h-pawn sacrifice for lines	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name Black's strongest counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.